



LME KNITTING PATTERN

LME MINI & ME PONCHO FOR BABY, WITH HOOD

SIZE 50-92

A soft, easy-knit baby poncho with a hood. The poncho itself is knitted in the round from the top down as one continuous piece, exactly like the kids' and adult versions: with eight even increase lines, a continuous i-cord edge and one fastening on each side. At the end, stitches are picked up along the neckline and the hood is knitted straight on, back and forth. No loose ties and no separate pieces to sew on.



By Renate Dahl

Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com



TIPS: Read the whole pattern once before you cast on. Always knit a gauge swatch first, see page 3.

BEFORE YOU START

First a low, soft ribbed neckline is knitted. Then the poncho is shaped in the round with eight even increase lines. After the last increase, knitting continues in the round to the hem. At the end, stitches are picked up along the neckline, and the hood is knitted back and forth straight onto the garment.

WHAT YOU LEARN

- to knit a low, soft ribbed neckline in 1 knit, 1 purl
- to knit in the round on a circular needle
- to increase evenly in eight sections
- to make a simple buttonhole on each side
- to bind off with i-cord all round the hem
- to pick up stitches along the neckline and knit a simple hood straight on

HOW HARD IS IT?

Easy to a little practised. You should be able to cast on, knit and purl, and knit in the round. Increases, buttonholes and i-cord bind-off are explained step by step. The hood shaping and joining the top are also explained step by step.

One step at a time, and in the end you have a poncho.

WHAT YOU NEED

YARN

DROPS Air (65% alpaca, 28% polyamide, 7% wool, 50 g = approx. 150 m). The poncho is knitted with one strand.

Size	Amount	Skeins
50	100 g	2
56	100 g	2
62	150 g	3
68	150 g	3
74	200 g	4
80	200 g	4
86	250 g	5
92	250 g	5

NEEDLES AND KIT

- 4.5 mm circular needle, 40 cm, for the neckline
- 5 mm circular needle, 60–100 cm, for the poncho and the hood
- double-pointed needles or magic loop, if you prefer
- 8 stitch markers and 4 removable markers
- 2 flat buttons, approx. 15–18 mm, sewn on very securely
- tapestry needle and tape measure

GAUGE

17 stitches and 22 rows in stockinette = 10 × 10 cm on 5 mm needles after washing and drying. Knit a swatch. Change needle size if your gauge does not match.

SIZES AND MEASUREMENTS

FROM NEWBORN TO 2 YEARS

Choose first by age or usual size. The poncho has plenty of ease. Sizes follow the child's body length. Full length is measured from the neckline to the hem. Width is measured flat across the unbuttoned poncho. Hood height is measured from the neckline to the top.

Size	Age	Stitches	Width	Length	Hood
50	newborn	152	ca. 45 cm	ca. 20 cm	ca. 16 cm
56	0–1 mo	152	ca. 45 cm	ca. 22 cm	ca. 17 cm
62	1–3 mo	160	ca. 47 cm	ca. 24 cm	ca. 18 cm
68	3–6 mo	176	ca. 52 cm	ca. 27 cm	ca. 19 cm
74	6–9 mo	192	ca. 56 cm	ca. 30 cm	ca. 20 cm
80	9–12 mo	216	ca. 64 cm	ca. 33 cm	ca. 21 cm
86	12–18 mo	232	ca. 68 cm	ca. 36 cm	ca. 22 cm
92	18–24 mo	248	ca. 73 cm	ca. 39 cm	ca. 23 cm

SAFETY FOR BABY

- ☐ The hood has no ties or tassels.
- ☐ Buttons must be sewn on extra securely and checked before every use.
- ☐ The garment should not be used during sleep or unsupervised.
- ☐ Take the poncho off in a car seat and other harness systems.
- ☐ Make sure the hood and neckline never cover the child's face.

Try the poncho on as you go. The length can easily be adjusted before the buttonholes are knitted.

TECHNIQUES AND NECKLINE

GLOSSARY

Term	Means
st	stitch
rnd	round
k / p	knit / purl
inc 1, leaning left	insert the left needle from the front under the strand between two stitches and knit it twisted, through the back loop
inc 1, leaning right	insert the left needle from the back under the strand between two stitches and knit it through the front loop, not twisted
stockinette in the round	all stitches knitted plain
i-cord	narrow knitted cord edge

1 - NECKLINE

Cast on with the 4.5 mm circular needle:

Size	Cast on	Rib height
50	56 m	2 cm
56	56 m	2 cm
62	64 m	2 cm
68	64 m	2 cm
74	64 m	2.5 cm
80	72 m	2.5 cm
86	72 m	2.5 cm
92	72 m	2.5 cm

Join in the round without twisting the work. Place a clear round marker at centre back. Knit *1 knit, 1 purl* in the round until the neckline has the given height.

Switch to the 5 mm needle and knit 1 plain round.

ROUND INCREASE SECTION

2 - PLACE THE MARKERS

Divide the stitches into 8 equal sections with markers. The round marker is also the first increase marker.

Size	Stitches per section
50	7
56	7
62	8
68	8
74	8
80	9
86	9
92	9

INCREASE ROUND

3 - INCREASE ROUND

Knit to 1 stitch before the marker. Increase 1 stitch leaning left. Move the marker over. Increase 1 stitch leaning right. Repeat at all 8 markers. This increases 16 stitches.

Then knit 1 whole round plain with no increases. Repeat these two rounds until the right stitch count is reached:

Size	Increase rounds	Stitches after increases	Approx. length
50	6	152	ca. 7 cm
56	6	152	ca. 7 cm
62	6	160	ca. 8 cm
68	7	176	ca. 9 cm
74	8	192	ca. 10 cm
80	9	216	ca. 11 cm
86	10	232	ca. 12 cm
92	11	248	ca. 13 cm



TIPS: How to increase: For a stitch leaning left, insert the left needle from the front under the strand between two stitches and knit it twisted, through the back loop. For a stitch leaning right, insert the left needle from the back under the strand between two stitches and knit it through the front loop, not twisted. The two new stitches then lean away from each other, giving a neat, symmetrical line out from each marker.

Checkpoint: The right stitch count matters most. If the height is off, keep knitting with no increases until the work has the given length.

KNIT ON IN THE ROUND

4 - THE WHOLE PONCHO

Remove the 7 ordinary increase markers, but keep the round marker at centre back. Knit all stitches plain in the round with no more increases. Continue until the work measures approx. 1.5 cm less than the given full length.

Size	Stop at
50	18.5 cm
56	20.5 cm
62	22.5 cm
68	25.5 cm
74	28.5 cm
80	31.5 cm
86	34.5 cm
92	37.5 cm

SIDE FASTENING

5 - SIDE FASTENING

Lay the work flat with the round marker at centre back. Find the middle of each side.

Count the given number of stitches from the side middle towards the front and place a marker for the button. Count the same number of stitches towards the back and place a marker for the buttonhole.

Size	Stitches
50	8
56	9
62	10
68	11
74	12
80	13
86	14
92	15

The work is still one whole, unbroken circle. Nothing is split.

BUTTONHOLE AND I-CORD EDGE

PLACEMENT FROM CENTRE BACK

Point	Knapphull 1	Knapp 1	Knapp 2	Knapphull 2
50	30	46	106	122
56	29	47	105	123
62	30	50	110	130
68	33	55	121	143
74	36	60	132	156
80	41	67	149	175
86	44	72	160	188
92	47	77	171	201

6 - BUTTONHOLE

Knit to the first buttonhole marker: yarn over, k2tog. Knit to the next buttonhole marker and repeat. Finish the round. Then knit 1 whole plain round, also across the yarn overs.

7 - I-CORD EDGE

Cast on 3 new stitches on the left needle using the knitted cast-on method. Knit 2. Knit the next i-cord stitch together with the next poncho stitch through the back loop. Slide the 3 stitches back without turning. Repeat all round the hem. Sew the beginning and end neatly together.



TIPS: Knitted cast-on: knit into the last stitch on the left needle as usual, but do not slip the old stitch off. Place the new stitch you just knitted back onto the left needle. Repeat until you have cast on 3 new stitches.

The i-cord edge runs continuously all round the poncho.

THE HOOD

8 - PICK UP STITCHES

Start at centre front of the neckline with the 5 mm needle. Pick up 1 stitch in the outer strand of every cast-on stitch all round the neckline. You should end up with the same stitch count as your cast-on:

Size	Stitches for hood
50	56 m
56	56 m
62	64 m
68	64 m
74	64 m
80	72 m
86	72 m
92	72 m

The hood is now knitted back and forth. Knit the first and last 4 stitches plain on every row. Between the edge stitches, knit stockinette.

9 - SHAPE THE TOP

Place a marker after a quarter of the stitches, and a marker after three quarters of the stitches. Knit until the hood measures approx. 4 cm less than the finished height.

On the next right-side row: *knit to 2 stitches before the marker, k2tog, move the marker, slip 1 stitch, knit 1, pass the slipped stitch over.* Repeat at both markers. This decreases 4 stitches. Repeat this row on every right-side row, the number of times given in the table:

Size	Repeat on every RS row	Finished hood height
50	2 times	16 cm
56	2 times	17 cm
62	3 times	18 cm
68	3 times	19 cm
74	4 times	20 cm
80	4 times	21 cm
86	5 times	22 cm
92	5 times	23 cm

CLOSE THE HOOD

10 - TOP SEAM

Continue knitting with no more decreases until the finished height. Divide the stitches evenly onto two needles. Fold the hood with right sides together, so the two face-opening edges line up. Bind off the top together with a 3-needle bind-off. Fasten off and turn the hood right side out again.

3-needle bind-off: two stitches are knitted together (one from each needle) and bound off at the same time, all the way across.

FINISHING

11 - THE BUTTONS

Sew one button on securely at each marker on the front part, right above the i-cord edge. Button each one through the buttonhole on the back part on the same side. The back part lies over the front part. Use strong sewing thread or double strands of yarn. Sew through the buttonholes many times and fasten off on the wrong side. Check that the child cannot pull the button loose.

FINISHING TOUCHES

- ☐ Weave in all ends on the wrong side.
- ☐ Soak the garment in lukewarm water with wool wash. Do not rub or wring.
- ☐ Press the water out in a towel. Shape the hood, neckline and hem, and dry flat.
- ☐ Check the buttons after drying and before every use. Sew them extra securely.

IMPORTANT

This is an outer garment for supervised use. The child should not sleep in the poncho or wear it in a car seat. The hood should never cover the face. Remove the garment immediately if a button or thread comes loose.

Before this pattern is sold: every size must be test-knitted, measured after washing and technically checked.

Happy knitting!



Renate Dahl

Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com

© 2026 Little Montessori Explorers. This pattern is for personal use only. The pattern may not be copied, shared, resold or published. Finished items may be sold on a small scale with credit to Little Montessori Explorers.